

To the Federal Communications Commission:

My name is Marielle Friedman, and I am writing from Richmond, California, USA. I am concerned about Reflect Orbital's proposal [SAT-LOA-20260108-00016] and its potential impacts on the night environment.

I am a PhD Candidate in Entomology who studies the effects of light pollution on invertebrates, plants, and ecosystem function. There is strong evidence documented in many peer-reviewed articles that light pollution (artificial light at night) has significant negative effects on many organisms, including human beings. Light pollution is the most rapidly growing form of pollution in the world and its effects are still not fully understood. Introducing more light pollution into the environment will likely have disastrous effects for global ecosystems and threaten the health of all organisms.

I urge the Federal Communications Commission to reject this proposal in its current form. While satellites play an important role today, deploying constellations at the scale proposed would dramatically expand human activity in low Earth orbit, with global environmental, scientific, and cultural consequences.

Key concerns include:

- **Orbital congestion:** Increasing the number of active satellites by roughly 70 times, raising the risk of collisions and cascade failures.
- **Atmospheric impacts:** Increased pollution from frequent launches and satellite re-entries, with long-term effects that remain poorly understood.
- **Loss of the night sky:** Light scattered from satellite surfaces would contribute to rising skyglow and erode humanity's view of the stars.
- **Ecosystem disruption:** Further interference with natural cycles of light and darkness that wildlife and ecosystems depend on.

These impacts are documented in scientific literature and are not speculative. Once deployment begins at this scale, the consequences would be difficult, if not impossible, to reverse.

For these reasons, I respectfully urge the FCC to require a comprehensive environmental review of large-scale satellite deployments, consistent with the National Environmental Policy Act, and to pause approval or expansion toward million-satellite architectures until such review is completed and publicly evaluated.

Innovation must advance alongside environmental responsibility. Until these risks are fully assessed through a transparent, science-based process, this proposal should not move forward.

Sincerely,

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